PAID MEDIA SPECIALIST

Andrew Fonseka.

Paid media judged on customers, not clicks. I connect ad platforms to CRM outcomes so budget follows **qualified leads, applications, enrolments and funded accounts.**

GOOGLE ADS · META · LINKEDIN · MICROSOFT ADS · MEASUREMENT



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OVERVIEW

Three operating models. One scoreboard.

7-figure
ANNUAL BUDGET CO-MANAGED
Aegon · U.S. and Canada

50 + ~100
BUSINESS-UNIT AD ACCOUNTS
Owned · co-managed with the team

6
MARKETS
CA · US · SA · LK · SG · MY

3 yrs
HANDS-ON PAID MEDIA
Agency · in-house · contract

01 / IN-HOUSE

Aegon

Regulated financial services. LinkedIn-led media for insurance and wealth products, CRM-driven bidding and compliant workflows across U.S. and Canada.

02 / CONTRACT

Contract · 2026

Part-time lead generation tied to client CRM outcomes in education, local services, automotive and hospitality, outside financial services.

03 / AGENCY

Kites Global · Enfection

Multi-client delivery in banking, retail and consumer brands across Sri Lanka, Singapore and Malaysia.

IN THIS PORTFOLIO 03 · CRM-connected bidding 04 · Measurement & automation 05 · University enrolments 06 · Bank lending 07 · Trades education

FINANCIAL SERVICES · GOOGLE ADS, META & HUBSPOT · H1 2026

Bid on pipeline, not form fills.

THE PROBLEM

Smart Bidding and Meta optimized to form submissions, which said little about who became a qualified applicant.

WHAT I CHANGED

- Fed HubSpot stages (qualified lead, booked call, completed application) back as **offline conversions**
- Restructured Google Ads accounts around those stages and tightened targeting
- Refined the contact page, lead forms and landing pages
- Reallocated budget toward what produced applications

THE LEARNING

Bidding gets smarter when the algorithm sees what sales sees.

−13%
COST PER LEAD
H1 2026

+18%
COMPLETED APPLICATIONS
Same period

0% change in media spend
Gains came from signal, structure and conversion experience.

OPTIMIZATION POINT MOVED DOWN THE FUNNEL



GA4 · SERVER-SIDE GTM · ENHANCED CONVERSIONS · META CAPI · APPS SCRIPT

Trust the data. Then automate.

+25%	5-figure	−60%	~12 days
META EVENT MATCH QUALITY	ANNUAL WASTED SPEND CUT	COMPLIANCE REVIEW TIME	WORKING TIME SAVED / YEAR

FIX THE SIGNAL

- Audit found overlapping GTM tags **double-counting** clicks, key events and conversions
- Rebuilt on GA4, server-side GTM, Enhanced Conversions and Meta CAPI with clean browser-server deduplication
- Corrected data reset reported CPA and budget decisions, and informed the decision to **end one agency contract and bring the work in-house**

AUTOMATE THE REPEATABLE

- Built a **Google Apps Script campaign builder** that enforces account structure, naming, UTM and compliance QA
- Adopted team-wide; routine account checks automated with Google Ads Scripts



ALSO BUILT AT AEGON

LinkedIn ABM for high-net-worth investors

Planned and launched a new account-based program in H1 2026 using Matched Audiences, Thought Leader Ads and carousel creative, measured on funded investment accounts rather than clicks. Results are confidential and can be verified through references at the offer stage.

CONTRACT VIA PARTNER AGENCY · SAUDI ARABIA · META LEAD FORMS · CRM-MATCHED ENROLMENTS

Optimize for enrolments, not form fills.

821
META LEADS

430
QUALIFIED LEADS

312
FEE-PAID ENROLMENTS
Matched on name, phone, student ID

~US$20
PER ENROLMENT
~US$6.2K total spend

THE PROBLEM

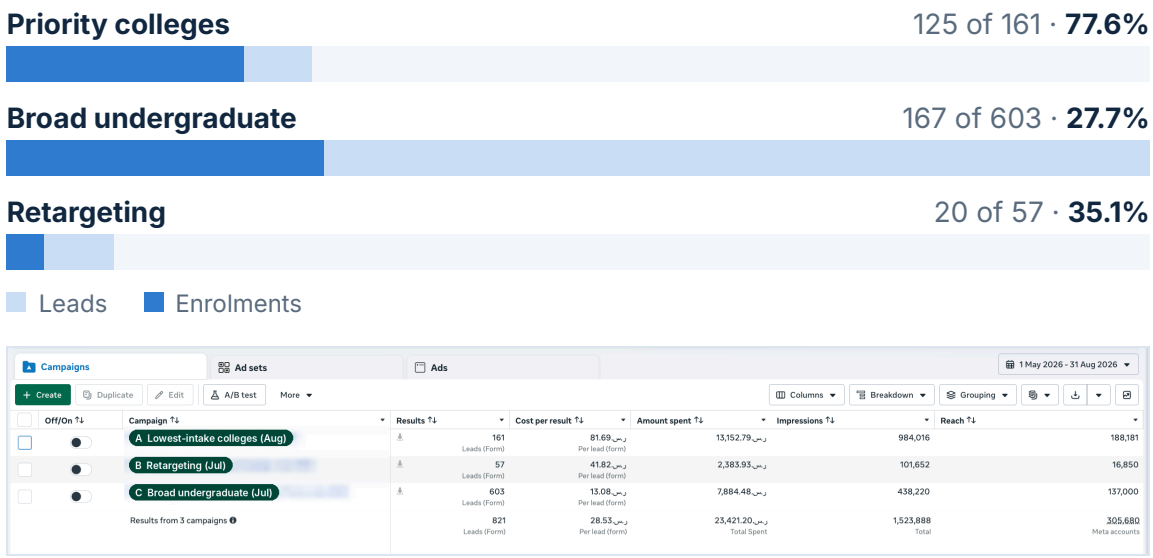
Two colleges had the lowest intakes. The broad campaign delivered only 17 enrolments for them.

THE DECISION

A dedicated campaign with a **higher-intent lead form**, its own budget, tighter placements and targeting, and A/B-tested creative.

> **Clean count:** enrolments were matched in the university CRM and deduplicated against people who were already applying.

LEADS → ENROLMENTS BY CAMPAIGN



Meta Ads Manager, 1 May – 31 Aug 2026 · institution identifiers removed · spend in SAR

KITES GLOBAL AGENCY ENGAGEMENT · SRI LANKA · META & GOOGLE ADS

Follow the leads that become loans.

THE PROBLEM

Win borrowers in a competitive gold-loan market on a fixed budget.

THE SIGNAL

Meta produced higher-quality leads at a lower cost per lead than Google Ads.

THE DECISION

Split budget **60% Meta / 40% Google** and judged it weekly on funded loans, not forms.



THE LEARNING

A low CPL means little until qualified leads become funded loans.

259	~US$97
FUNDED GOLD LOANS	MEDIA COST PER FUNDED LOAN
US$25K	US$500K
MEDIA SPEND	LOAN VALUE Client-reported

> US$500K is client-reported loan principal, not bank revenue, so the ratio is not ROAS.

CONTRACT · TRADES EDUCATION · GOOGLE ADS, META, MICROSOFT ADS & AN AI ENQUIRY JOURNEY

More qualified leads. Same budget.

THE SIGNAL

CRM-qualified leads in Dynamics 365, not raw form fills, exposed where the funnel was leaking.

THE DECISION

- Rebuilt Google Ads and Meta campaigns
- Added **Microsoft Advertising** as a new source of intent
- Simplified the landing page and launched a **24/7 AI enquiry assistant**

~US$900 per month, unchanged

MEDIA BUDGET

+20%

CRM-QUALIFIED LEADS

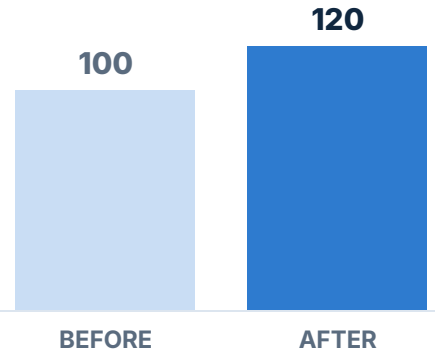
At flat spend

4×

FASTER ENQUIRY REPLIES

AI assistant vs. manual

CRM-QUALIFIED LEADS · INDEX (BEFORE = 100)



40%

of 212 leads came from Microsoft Ads in the engagement's second quarter.

APPROACH

A better signal. A better decision.

01
Find the constraint
Audit tracking, search terms, creative, landing pages and CRM quality.

02
Define the outcome
Agree the business result and build the channel mix around it.

03
Test what matters
Prioritized experiments with success criteria set up front.

04
Scale on evidence
Report outcomes and move budget to what works.

05
Systemize
Document results and automate the repeatable.

PAID MEDIA

Google Ads · Microsoft Ads · Meta · LinkedIn · TikTok · Performance Max · Demand Gen

MEASUREMENT

GA4 · Server-side GTM · Meta CAPI · Enhanced Conversions · Offline conversions · Looker Studio

CRM & AUTOMATION

HubSpot · Dynamics 365 · Apps Script · Google Ads Scripts · Zapier · Supermetrics

LET'S TALK

Let's talk paid media.

Paid search, paid social and measurement for teams accountable to business outcomes.

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